

Alexander the Great.

BCE

- — After Alexander conquests (323) the Hellenistic period began, when Greek culture blended with Egyptian, Persian, and Asian influences across a much larger empire.

Medieval Christianity:

Church, Charlemagne and the Carolingians.

1. The Church in Medieval Christianity.

* The Church was central to medieval life, influencing politics, education, and everyday culture.

* The Pope was considered the spiritual leader of Christendom and claimed authority overall.

Date _____ Day _____
Christian rulers.

* Monasteries preserved learning and were centers of literacy and manuscript copying.

* Canon Law (Church Law) governed religious practices and often clashed or blended with secular law.

* The church used tools like excommunication and indirect to enforce its power.

2. Charlemagne (Charles the Great)

* Ruled from 768 - 814 first as king of Franks, then as Emperor of Carolingian Empire.

* Crowned emperor of the Romans by pope Leo III in 800, symbolizing the fusion of Roman, Christian, and Germanic traditions.

* He saw the church as a

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vital partner in ruling a
sought to reform and strengthen
Christianity across his realm.

* Promoted Christian missionary
work, especially in newly
conquered lands (e.g., Saxons).

* Supported education and
scholarship, leading to the
Carolingian Renaissance, a revival
of art, culture and learning
under church patronage.

3. The Carolingian Dynasty

* The Frankish noble family
that rose to power in the
8th century, replacing the
Merovingians.

* Pepin the short, Charlemagne's
father, allied closely with the
Pope and was anointed king
with church blessing—an early
example of church-state alliance.

* Under Carolingian rule, the empire

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grew large and more unified.
with (example) Christianity
used as a unifying force.

* After Charlemagne, the empire
weakened due to internal
divisions, but the Church's
influence remained strong.

Key themes:-

- i- Mutual support between Church
and monarchy (Divine Right,
papal coronations).
 - ii- Religious unity as political
strategy.
 - iii- Spread the standardization
of Christianity through power
and education.
 - iv- Church's increasing temporal
power during and after
Charlemagne's reign.
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Medieval Christianity: Crusades and Byzantine Empire.

1. The Crusades (1095-1291)

The Crusades were a series of religious wars launched by Western Christians, mainly to reclaim the Holy Land (Jerusalem) from Muslim control and to defend Christendom.

Key Crusades:

First Crusade (1096-1099):

Called by Pope Urban II at the council of Clermont (1095); it successfully captured Jerusalem.

Second Crusade (1147-1149): A failed attempt to regain territory lost to Muslims.

Third Crusade (1189-1192): Led by Richard the Lionheart;

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Failed to recapture Jerusalem
but allowed Christian Pilgrims
access.

Fourth Crusade (1202-1204):

Derived from its goal and ended
with the Sack of Constantinople,
a Christian city, deepening the
divide between East and
West.

Later Crusades were less successful
and often politically motivated.

Impact of the Crusades:

- * Strengthened Papal authority
and religious zeal in Europe.
- * Deepened the East-West schism
between Roman Catholic and Eastern
orthodox churches.
- * Stimulated trades and cultural
exchange with the East (Byzantine
and Islamic Worlds).
- * Spread of military religious
orders like the knight Templar

and Hospitallers.

2. The Byzantine Empire and Christianity.

- The Byzantine Empire was the continuation of Eastern Roman Empire, with Constantinople as its capital.
- Its Christianity was Eastern Orthodox, distinct from Roman Catholicism.
- The Emperor had strong influence over the Church (Caesaropapism), unlike in the west where the Pope held spiritual authority.
- Church of Hagia (Sofia) Sophia symbolized Byzantine Christian culture.

East - West Schism (1054):

Final separation between Roman Catholic Church (West) and Eastern Orthodox Church

(East).

Causes: Disputes over papal authority, theology (e.g., Filioque clause), and cultural differences.

← The fourth Crusade's sack of Constantinople (1204) caused deep resentment in Byzantium.

Byzantine role in Christianity:

- Preserved early Christian traditions and theology.
- Influence Slavic Christianity, especially through missionaries like Saint Cyril and Methodius.
- Played a key role in Christian art, liturgy and monasticism.

Key themes:

- Religious warfare and Pilgrimage merged in the Crusades
- Conflict and cooperation (between Christianity's internal divisions:)

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Rome Vs. Byzantine traditions.

a. The Byzantine Empires as
a Christian stronghold and
cultural bridge between East
and West.
